~~Why~~ **How** To Create for TikTok

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The Opportunity

Execute with creative excellence across all touch points

01

Know the Codes

Create with confidence with TikTok's Creative Codes.

02

Create for the Ecosystem

Develop toolkits for full funnel creative success

03

Build Beyond

Build a full-funnel content and commerce engine to solidify category leadership.

TikTok's Creative Codes

1. TikTok-First

2. Structure

3. Stimulation

4. Sound

5. Trends

6. Production

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1

TikTok First

Create content authentic to TikTok & the FYP experience

TikTok-specific creative saw nearly...

3 Sec **Longer watch time**

and 1.2x stronger emotional response than adapted creative on TikTok

Entertainment

Focus on storytelling at the brand and product level

Authenticity

Partner with creators & lean into the culture

Co-creation

Create participatory brand moments

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Source:2. TikTok Marketing Science US Brand Building Study 2022, conducted by DIRT;

2

Structure

Experiment with story structures that create impact & value

38%

Lift in conversion

Ad Creatives with **multiple scenes** compared to Ad Creatives of one person in a continuous shot.

- Provocative initial hooks
- Compelling storytelling
- Anticipation drivers
- Attention rewards
- Close with intention

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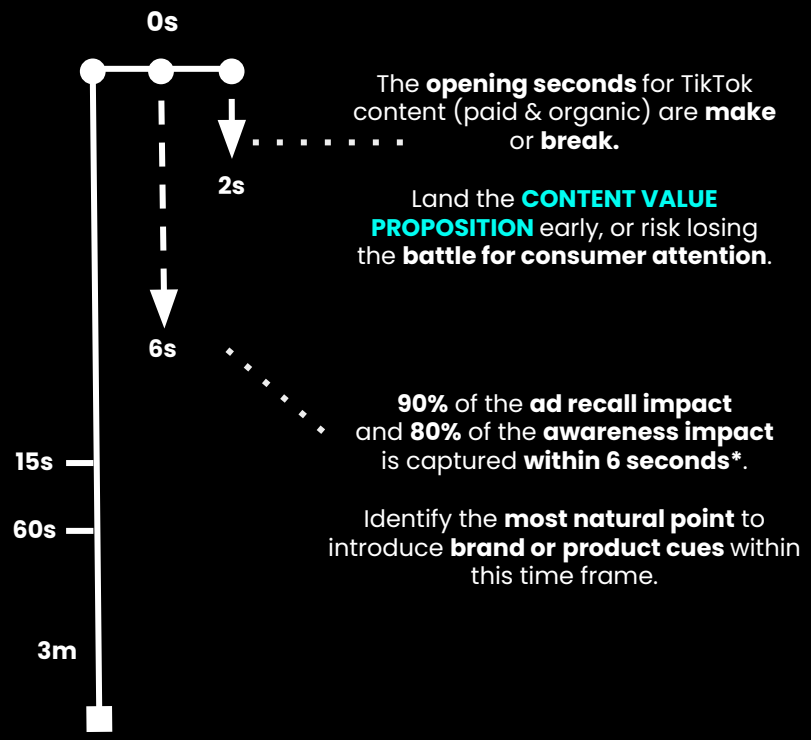
Source: TikTok Marketing Science Global Information Density 2022 conducted by Neuro-Insight

THE IMPORTANCE OF HOOKS

TikTok supports three length formats: 15sec, 60sec and 3min.

All these formats can find success, however research shows that regardless of format the **first six seconds are vital for attention, impact and attribution.**

FIRST STEP:
Focus on your hook and work out where your brand/product can be additive to the content



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Source: TikTok, "Creative Guide: Driving Brand Equity", 2020 (TikTok "Value of View" Analysis)

3

Stimulation

Maintain engagement with attention triggers

59 %

of ads with a high number (4-5) attention triggers perform above ad memorability benchmarks.

Source: TikTok Marketing Science Global Information Density 2022 conducted by Neuro-Insight

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USE ATTENTION TRIGGERS

Stimulation

Tools proven to maintain active attention.

MUSIC

Faster paced music was found to **boost neuro activity** associated with **ad memorability.**

TRANSITIONS

Fast scene changes draw users in early and **increase chances** of **making an impression** on users.

MOVEMENT

Movement within an assets **catches the users eye and keeps the narrative moving.**

TEXT

Visual guidance such as text pop-ups **sustain high engagement** among viewers.

EMOJIS

Emoji's can help to **humanise your content**, **conveying tone** in a simple, playful manner that **feels TikTok First.**

BRAND

Increased brand visibility or early product placement improves **ad effectiveness, memorability, brand recall.**

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Source: TikTok Marketing Science Global Information Density 2022 conducted by Neuro-Insight

4

Sound

Think sound on to ensure your message is heard loud and clear

55 %

lift in communicating new information using TikTok's sound-on solutions

Music

Layer videos with custom, owned, or **commercial music library**

Voiceover

Create guides, how to's, reviews, and narration

Sounds

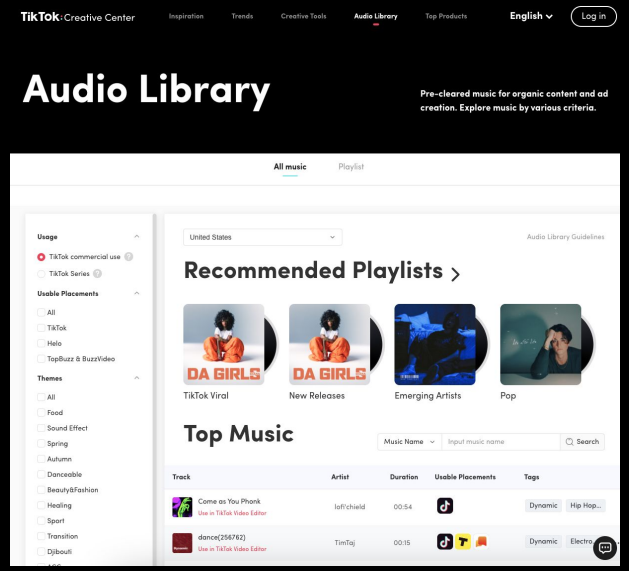
Sync sounds to visual moments/triggers

Source: US Marketing Science Cross-Platform Sound Research, conducted by Kantar, Jan 2021

Tune in for sound inspiration

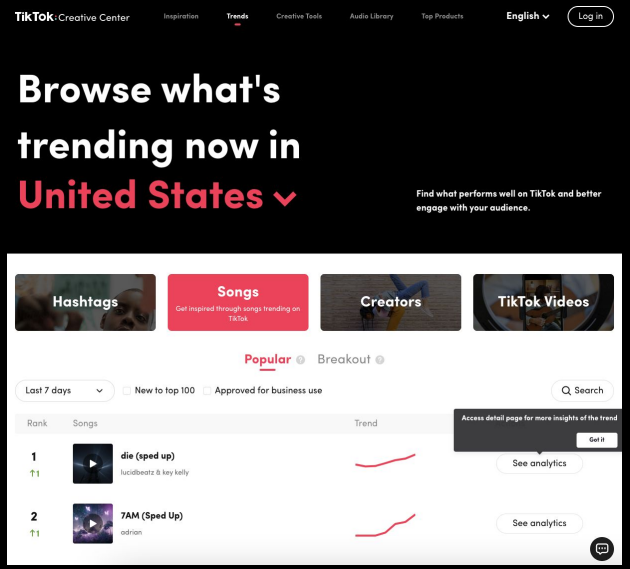
Sound

Pre-Cleared Commercial Music Library



What's New:
1M+ songs
Playlisting
Real Artists Music

On Trend



What's New:
Trending music by region
Filter for business use

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Tap the trends for inspiration and increased relevance

77 %

Of TikTok users like it when brands use trends, memes, or challenges on TikTok to make new content.

HOW TO FIND A TREND

- SCROLL FYP
- SEARCH HASHTAGS
- USE CREATIVE CENTER
- ENGAGE THE COMMUNITY

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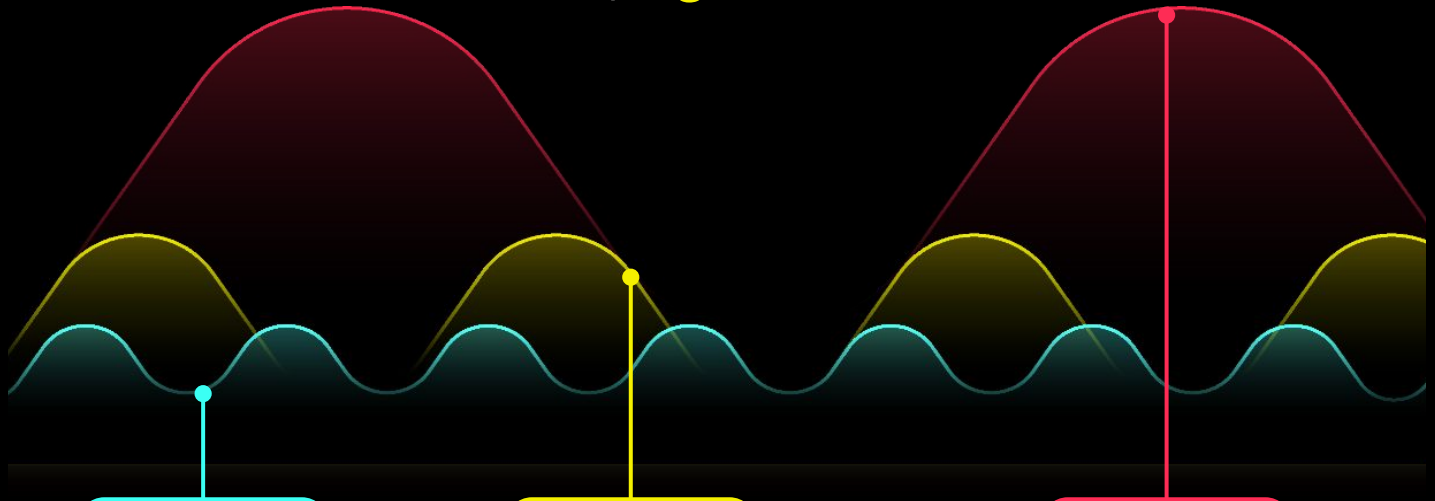
Source: TikTok Marketing Science Global Community and Self-Expression Study 2021 conducted by Flamingo

Trends

TikTok Trends evolve at warp speed. We categorize these cultural touchstones as "moments, signals & forces"



Moments

Creative prompts that quickly gain traction and buzz.

Signals

Content patterns that show emerging behaviors and interests.

Forces

Enduring large-scale behavioral transformations.

fleeting → *enduring*

Link Out: What's Next 2024 Shopping Trend Report

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Trends

For best results, leverage our trends with a top-down approach starting with forces

Community Commerce

Unlocks: Creative Theme

Trend Forces give you a lens to focus your efforts by key themes (i.e influence), demonstrating how to be TikTok-first in those areas

Show, Don't Sell

Little Luxe

Shoppable Comm. Aesthetic

Unlocks: Creative Formats

Trend Signals help determine unique creative opportunities to resonate with audiences on TIkTok

#Shopping Haul

#Treat Yourself

#CozyGamer Setup

#Unboxing

Unlocks: Creative Context

Trend Moments can help brands sustain audience relationships + stay top of mind

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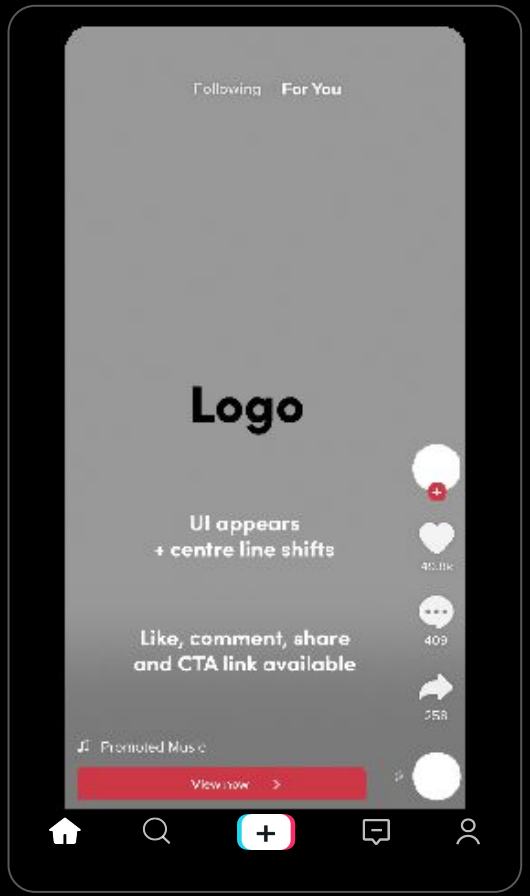
6

Production

Fine tune your production process

- Full-screen, vertical video
- Keep it high res
- Respect the safe zones
- Use creative tools (CapCut)
- Keep creative fresh
- Maximize shoots of all sizes



RECUT

existing creative assets for TikTok

REMIX

creative assets to be more TikTok

REIMAGINE

your creative approach using the power of TikTok

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Source: TikTok Marketing Science Global Community and Self-Expression Study 2021 conducted by Flamingo

Production

Ad Group Level

Creative Quantity & Diversity

4+

The ad group has more than 4 creative assets

8 days

Assets to be refreshed every 8 days approx

Leverage Creative Tools such as TTCX for assistance with “remixing” existing creative to keep your brand’s #ForYou content strategy fresh.

- A high number of creative assets allows for a better optimization of asset selection, allowing the system to quickly learn what works for each brand and each campaign
- More creative assets in one ad group can bring higher impression rates, shelf life and cold start pass rate
- Keep refreshing and uploading new video to your campaign until you find your winners
- Data tells us that adding new creative assets, roughly, once every 8 days is the optimal practice

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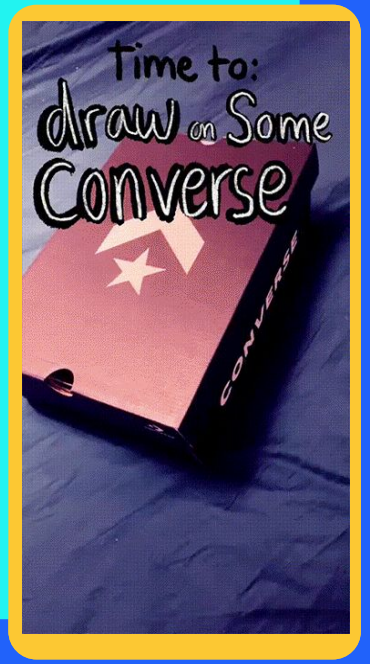
Production

Creative Asset Level



Shoot **high-res**

Ensure video resolution of 720P+

312% **lift in conversion** compared to other video resolutions

Go big with **full-screen**

Stick to a 9:16 aspect ratio

91% **lift in conversion** compared to videos that are not formatted to screen (with empty black space on any of the sides)

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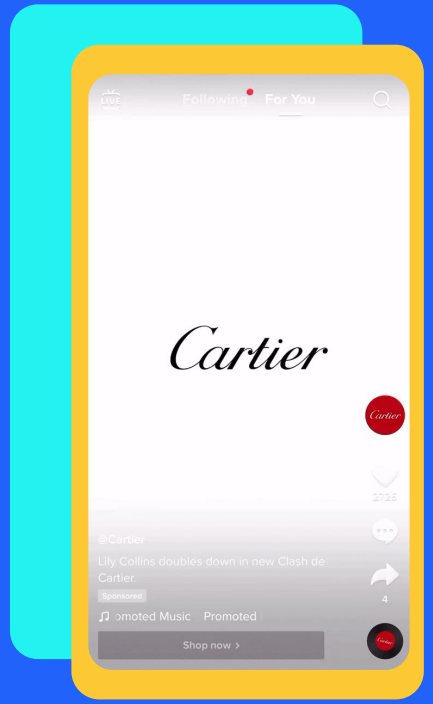
Production

Creative Asset Level



TikTok is sound–on by default

Include audio. The more relevant, the better

16% **lift in impressions** compared to videos with no audio.

The first few seconds are make-or-break

50% of total impact to recall and awareness occurs in the **first 2 and 2.5 seconds**, respectively.
Optimal creative length is less definitive.

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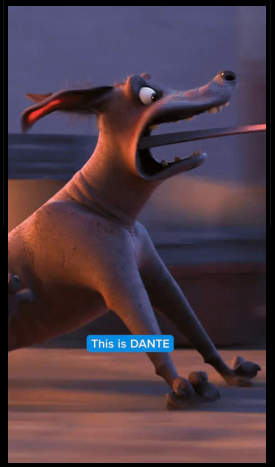
Production

Keep it fresh to increase engagement

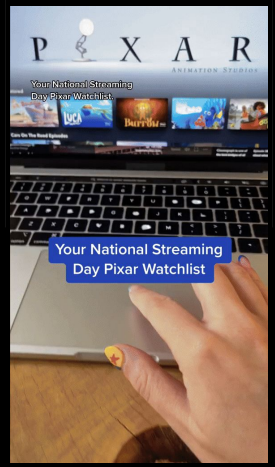
RECUT | REMIX | REIMAGINE

Traditional Creative



Native Creative

Creator Content



Community Engagement

Audience Activation

Lift from ads built natively & repurposed for TikTok

- **+8%** Brand Favorability
- **+6%** Purchase Intent
- **+7%** Search Intent

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CREATIVE CHEATSHEET

TIKTOK FIRST

Understanding TikTok First - what makes Branded content unique to TikTok?

How can you go TikTok First through creators?

If you need to adapt existing assets, establish which editing tricks to use to appear TikTok First

HOOK

How do you hook your audience?

What type of hook will you use?

Can you credibly feature your brand of product in the hook?

STRUCTURE

Choose a narrative structure that best fits your creative idea

Is it short: 'A-ha'
Medium: 'Solution-Problem'
Long: 'Journey'

Understand how that impacts the story of your asset

KEY MESSAGING

What key messages do you need to land?

How will you intro the content value proposition

Where will your brand/product naturally appear?

Is your CTA clear and concise both in content and captions?

STIMULATION

Think about which event triggers you can use to keep and hold attention

How will you feature:
- Sound
- Scene changes
- Movement
- Product placement
- Text pop-ups

SOUND

What role will sound play?

Will it be:
- Music
- Voiceovers
- Sounds

Check licenses (N/A with commercial music library)

TRENDS

Is there an existing trend that I can use to help drive momentum?

Is it a:
- FORCE
- SIGNAL
- MOMENT

Am I executing it in a way where my brand, product and message is authentic?

PRODUCTION

Is my asset:
- Hi-res
- Framed 9:16
- Within the safe zone

Avoid creative fatigue by:
- Have 4+ assets in each ad group
- Refreshing them every 8-days*
- Leverage TTCX to refresh creative & combat creative fatigue

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*Source: TikTok Help Center

TikTok's Creative Toolbox

TikTok Creative Exchange (TTCX)

Video Content Package (VCP)

A **Video Content Package** grants advertisers fully funded, video production through our **vetted TTCX partners**, delivering **high-performing ad creatives** for TikTok.

Creator Led Package (CLP)

Our **Creator Led Package** provides **white-glove service** where we partner with our heavily vetted partner agencies to **source and contract creators** directly. Fully handling campaign management end-to-end.

TikTok Creative Challenge (TTCC)

TikTok Creative Challenge enables advertisers to create fully funded, authentic TikTok **ad content at scale using TikTok Creators**. Creators make ad creatives based on challenge requirements.

TikTok Creator Marketplace (TTCM)

The **TikTok Creator Marketplace** is a **self-serve digital portal** that makes finding potential **creators** and forming long-lasting relationships easy.

Content produced by agencies

Content produced by creators

Brand Examples

Each of these brands have done a great job of encapsulating our 3 Creative Touchpoints.

COACH

crocs™

DIOR

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Build a full-funnel content and commerce engine to solidify category leadership.

Brand Examples

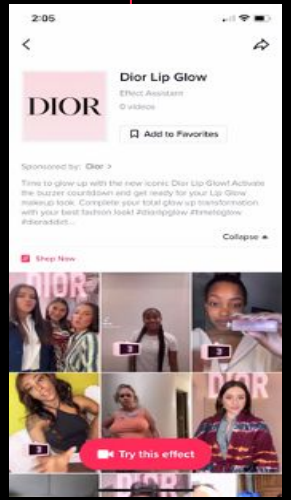
DIOR

Since Dior launched on TikTok, they have built a platform-native creative strategy from the ground up, using our Creative Codes as a guiding light throughout their journey

Launch with brand assets

TopView

Invite Community to Participate



Branded Mission

Drive engagement and consideration

Branded Effect

Inspire purchase

Video Shopping Ad

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Brand Examples

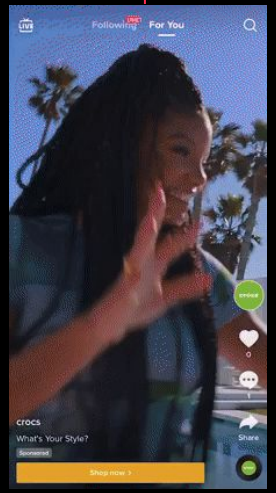
crocs™

Crocs leverages interactive add-ons and diverse creative to engage users

Cue a reaction to trigger engagement

TopView with Shake Surprise

Allowing audience choice



TopFeed with Story Selection

Leaning into trends & sounds

In Feed Video

Organic comments

Organic Post

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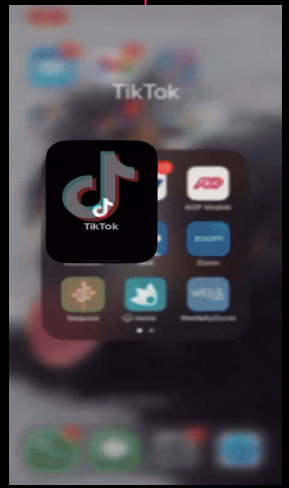
Brand Examples

COACH

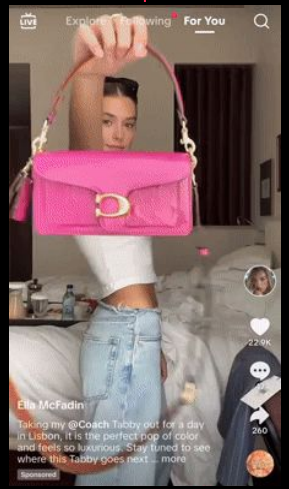
Coach makes use of TikTok tools to activate across the full-funnel

Leverage celebrity recognition



TopView

Stand out with interactive add ons



Pop Out Showcase

Engage with Community

Comment Reply

Inspire purchase

Video Shopping Ad

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Creative Thought Starters

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Behind the Scenes

Content that provides the community a peek behind the curtain on how things are made, run or done. For brands it also gives never-before-seen perspective, like how packages are packed to mail out to buyers, a look behind the scenes at a photoshoot, or a sneak peek into an upcoming drop.

How can your brand provide a unique perspective?

"After seeing that **behind the scenes** TikTok from Chipotle, I know why their guac is so addictive. "

Featured TikTok

@niccilewis, a photographer, gives a behind the scenes look at photoshoot for **Adidas**

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Content Series

A concept for a TikTok that is repeated over time, either as storytelling broken out across episodes or simply a repeated trope. TikToks can now be organized into Playlists, letting viewers easily find grouped content.

How might your brand's story be told over time? Do you have a content that's doing well that could turn into a series?

"I am so invested in Lubalin's Internet Drama series. What song will he do next?"

Featured TikTok

@remibader does an **Abercrombie** haul where she tries the products she is unboxing

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How To

A genre of TikTok that teaches viewers how to do something new, from how to do drag makeup, to how to tint car windows, to how to travel for free.

"How-to" videos are category agnostic and show up in every niche community that exists on TikTok, including but not limited to sports and clothing.

"I learned how to hide the cables behind my desk from watching a TikTok video!"

How can you leverage "how-to" content to help your audience learn how to use your product?

What skills or tips would help your audience meet their goals?

Featured TikTok

@timdessaint created a video on how to style **Converse** high tops

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Occupation

Creators with different or unique occupations sharing their expertise and their unique daily routines. From social media managers to sales associates, TikTok offers a glimpse into different careers and jobs unknown to many.

"I've found a professional window cleaner on TikTok and I'm obsessed."

Are there unique roles in the creation or implementation of your product you could share with TikTok?

Featured TikTok

A video producer for **American Eagle** gives a peak into his work trip from Pittsburgh, PA to Anchorage, AK

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POV

"Point of view" videos that showcase a unique or unexpected perspectives. They are often category agnostic, so they can show up across all the different TikTok communities. The traditional TikTok POV is shot from a first-person perspective, making the viewers the main character of the video. Many POVs are built on relatable moments, but with alt TikTok, the more surprising, niche or weird the POV, the better.

> "I never thought I'd see the POV of my Lip Smacker lip gloss from 2002, but here we are."

How can your brand use POV to communicate a specific customer perspective?

Would you lean into a comedic angle with POV even if your brand doesn't typically do humor?

Featured TikTok

Gap gives a peek into the perspective of a teacher and his students for the #GapToSchool campaign

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Transition

Using clever editing and in-app camera tricks to create a surprising shift from one state to another. Often used to change scenes or outfits, common transitions include covering and uncovering the camera, fast swipes of the camera creating a blur, and positioning a new clip in the exact positioning of a previous clip.

"Not only do I love this Creator's outfits, I love the unique transitions that she creates."

How might transitions be used to show before-and- after brand experience?

Featured TikTok

Hollister worked with creator, @jeanvictorm, to shows off some outfits in a dance transition video

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